

Cohen Dropped After One Year

By MAX GREENWALD

A resident of Indianapolis is among the candidates for the just-vacated position of manager of the Indians.

He is Johnny Hutchings, popular coach of the Tribe who has had long experience as a pitcher in the big leagues and at Indianapolis.

"I'm definitely interested," Big John said yesterday. "It is my ambition to be a manager and I certainly would like to start here in AAA."

Hutchings has been in baseball since 1935. A native of Chicago, he has lived here since 1948. He first pitched for the Tribe in 1942.

IF THERE was a department which could be blamed for the downfall of the Indians the past season, it was pitching.

Andy Cohen, who was dropped yesterday after one season as Indianapolis manager, had troubles with his hurling almost from the start.

In spring training, it appeared the mound work would be a strong point for the Indians. But it didn't turn out that way and how much responsibility can be placed on Cohen can only be conjecture.

But the campaign wasn't very far along before some of the pitchers complained they had no idea when they were going to work. Veterans Tony Ponce and Al Papai, who dote on pitching consistently, were used infrequently.

In fact, Papai went from June 22 until July 10 without working an inning. For some reason, Cohen lost confidence in the moundsman who had a 20-10 record in 1956 in the Southern Association. Papai was 5-12 this year.

WHEN A club finishes sixth, as the Indians did the past campaign, the manager is an easy target for criticism. For instance, Cohen attempted a running game when there was only one fast man on the team.

In pre-season guessing by American Association writers, Indianapolis was picked seventh. Cohen, himself, didn't feel his team was first-division caliber, especially after Outfielder Ted Beard went to the Chicago White Sox July 23.

Although the White Sox have adopted a hands-off attitude, the Chicago bigwigs believed Indianapolis should have done better.

The Indians have a working agreement with the Sox, who have tightened the bond between the teams with a \$50,000 "no-strings-attached" loan.

Cohen received word of his dismissal at Chicago where Owne Bush, Indians, Inc., president, and Ray Johnston, general manager, were present for White Sox organizational meetings.

"WE THINK it best to make a change for next year," Bush said. "Andy has always been a good friend of mine and still is."

"But he didn't satisfy us and didn't get the job done we thought could have been accomplished with the Indians this past season."

Under Kerby Farrell in 1956, using Cleveland farm players, the Indians gained the "triple crown"—winning the pennant.

American Association playoffs and the Little World Series.

AND, WITH things going badly at Cleveland, Farrell may be looking for an AAA job next season. Farrell won two championships and finished seventh in his three years at Indianapolis.

If a player-manager is in the cards, Beard would be a possibility. A smart player his entire career, Beard has become a keen student of managerial strategy.

Bush said he believed there "would be a lot of applications for the job." He said all applications will be screened before a choice is made.

